

Finally, after thirty hours, she gave birth to a daughter. The doctor feared that Mumtaz would not survive. The doctor was right.

Shah Jahan came to his wife’s side. She told him that this was “the time of departure.” She said that she had dreamed of a beautiful palace with a lush garden, the like of which she had never imagined. She asked Jahan to build a tomb like that for her. She wanted it to be so perfect, it would be like Heaven on earth.

She died in his arms as the sun rose the next day.